Layla Chen

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Education

Simon Fraser University Expected Graduation: May 2027
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science *Burnaby, BC*

- Relevant Coursework: Operating Systems, Data Structures and Algorithms, Systems Programming, Object-Oriented Design, Data Abstraction

Work Experience

Systems Developer Intern September 2025 – Present
Connor, Clark & Lunn Financial Group - Trading and Compliance *Vancouver, BC*

- Engineered a full-stack internal tool that visualizes configuration dependencies across multiple teams, improving transparency and reducing manual tracking time by over 50%
- Developed an interactive, scalable UI using Angular and Material Design components to enable users to easily compare and manage service variables across environments
- Implemented RESTful APIs in C# to integrate data from Azure DevOps, optimizing data retrieval and ensuring consistent, reliable access to system configurations
- Collaborated cross-functionally with developers, analysts, and compliance teams to scope features, conduct code reviews, and iteratively deliver production-ready enhancements

Math Teaching Assistant September 2023 - Present
Kumon Learning Centre *Vancouver, BC*

- Tutored students in advanced mathematics, fostering strong problem-solving skills and academic growth
- Provided support to students through pronunciation guidance, homework grading, and personalized tutoring
- Managed front-desk operations, organized materials, and maintained accurate records for a smooth experience

Personal Projects

Personal Finance Tracker | *Python, Flask, PostgreSQL, Docker* March 2025

- Built a RESTful API for finance tracking, enabling secure user authentication and efficient expense management
- Optimized PostgreSQL schemas, improving data retrieval speed by 40% through indexing and normalization
- Developed SQL queries for financial reporting, providing insights into spending patterns and budget analysis
- Enhanced scalability with Docker to automate deployment pipelines and reducing integration time by 30%

Mern Chat | *JavaScript, React, HTML, CSS* October 2024

- Developed a full-stack real-time chat application to create a dynamic UI, ensuring smooth user interactions
- Engineered a scalable backend with MongoDB, optimizing data storage for large-scale user experience
- Implemented real-time messaging with WebSockets enabling seamless low-latency communication between users
- Emphasized security by integrating encryption and anonymous user authentication to protect user data

Trip Planner | *Java, JUnit, JSON* May 2024

- Developed a travel planner with a GUI and console, enabling users to create trip itineraries and add reviews
- Implemented data persistence using JSON to allow users to save trip information and reload it across sessions
- Designed and executed unit tests for all core functionalities, improving code reliability and data retrieval
- Integrated a logging system that records and displays the details of actions in the console to optimize tracking

Blackfoot Language Game | *Python, Pygame, OpenCV* September 2023

- Developed an interactive Blackfoot language learning game, with real-time feedback to enhance user engagement
- Implemented flashcards with audio pronunciations, utilizing Pygame to create an immersive learning experience
- Used OpenCV for advanced image processing, applying matrix manipulation techniques to display 2D images
- Designed audio-visual components that enable users to hear correct pronunciations while learning vocabulary

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, Java, C, C++, SQL, JavaScript, Angular, HTML, CSS
Frameworks: React.js, Node.js, Next.js, JUnit, Docker, OpenCV, Flask
Developer Tools: Git, Github, Linux, VS Code, IntelliJ, Figma, MongoDB